

INDIA HAS ALWAYS been described as a land of paradoxes. Be it India's culture, diversity, or sheer population size, it is complicated and fascinating. For about two decades now, the engines of the nation's economic growth have been firing impressively. Companies have become larger and many have left a rather large global imprint.

So, India's presidency of the G20 forum that represents 85 per cent of global GDP and 75 per cent of international trade is hugely important as it comes at an inflection point, when a confident India Inc. is looking to flex its muscles globally after it breezed past the years of the pandemic and emerged relatively unscathed.

Nadir B. Godrej, Chairman & Managing Director of Godrej Industries, has seen the transition of India Inc. from close quarters. "Earlier, we had limited influence on the world stage but that has changed. Businesses are a lot more confident," he says. In many ways, the beginning of this new story was the opening of the economy in

the early 1990s. "Yes, it was hugely exciting but one was also scared. Our group worked with large global names through joint ventures and in the process, best practices were picked up."

GROWING INFLUENCE

That growing confidence is a reflection of the Indian economy's increasing clout. In just a decade, India has zoomed from being the tenth-largest economy to the fifth now. But that has not translated into commensurate influence on global policies. "India's G20 presidency is well-timed for it to exercise greater influence on the agenda and narrative on global policies across economic, social, environmental, and digital sectors. This is when we are the fastest-growing large economy in a polarising world

with elevated debt, decelerating growth, and rising uncertainty," says Ajit Pai, Partner (Government and Public Sector) at EY India.

The close coordination that the G20 platform has facilitated over the past year has had many benefits, he says. "More than 18 ministerial meetings, 80 at the working group level, and 33 engagement group meetings apart from numerous side events [have been held]. These interactions have not only given Indian officials and businesses insights into various aspects of global finance and development, but also access to the who's who of global decision-making," says Pai.

Besides, there is a separate track for business leaders, the B20 engagement group. Its summit will be held in New Delhi at the end of August, and will see the participation



India's G20 presidency will shape global policies around artificial intelligence, cryptocurrencies, semiconductors and big tech monopolies, among others



"[The] China+1 [strategy] is only one part to it. As a country, a lot of work has been done on developmental R&D (research and development) and we will now need to focus our attention on the fundamental part"

NADIR B. GODREJ

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